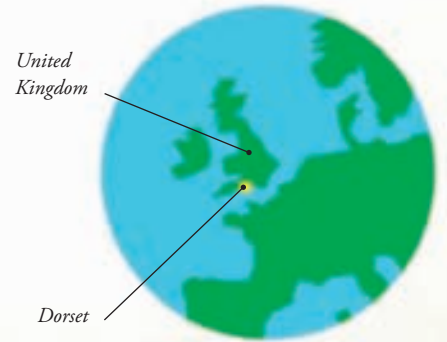


A young fossil hunter

In 1830, English geologist Henry De la Beche painted a curious watercolor with the intention of selling copies to raise money for a friend. The friend was Mary Anning, and the painting was the first time anyone had tried to draw a realistic picture of prehistoric life. Most amazing of all, Mary had discovered every animal in it.



A look back in time

De la Beche called his painting *Duria Antiquior*, or “A more ancient Dorset.”

It featured animals that Mary had found as fossils on the coast of Dorset in England. Prints of this painting were passed around scientific circles in the 1800s, and influenced thinking on prehistoric life.

The painting showed an ichthyosaur capturing a plesiosaur.